

Common Application | Undergraduate

Reese Carter | CAID: APP_014 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_014
First Name	Reese
Last Name	Carter
Date Of Birth	5/29/08
Mailing Address	1013 Prototype Road, Boston, MA 02108
Primary Phone Number	617-555-0113
Email Address	reese.carter.014@example.com
Gender	Female
Ethnicity	White
Country	USA
Region	Northeast

Education and application details

Reese Carter | CAID: APP_014 | Fall 2026

Name of HS	Boston High School
Counselor Name	Dakota Lopez
Intended Major	Philosophy
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	3.47
Weighted GPA	3.89
Rank	Not provided
Superscored SAT Score	31
Superscored ACT Score	Not provided

AP Courses

Not provided

Total APs

0

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Debate team member, Coding club member, Drama club performer, Animal shelter volunteer

Awards

Community service recognition

Hooks

First-Gen

Personal essay

Reese Carter | CAID: APP_014 | Fall 2026

Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

Learning to stay with a question

At debate practice, I prepared an argument so carefully that I stopped listening to the response. My partner pointed out an assumption I had treated as obvious. I could defend the wording, but I could not explain why the assumption should be accepted.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in Philosophy comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to ask better questions before defending an answer. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.